development on macOS, including David Heinemeier Hansson.[26]

- Sublime Text is a cross-platform alternative that some see as the de facto successor to TextMate.[27]
- rails.vim is a Vim/NeoVim plugin for editing Ruby on Rails applications.[28]
- RubyMine is a commercial IDE for Ruby and is available for free to qualified educational and open source projects.[29] It runs on Windows, macOS, and Linux.

Ask experienced developers who use your kind of operating system which editor they use. Spend a week or so trying alternatives before settling in.

The Desktop

We're not going to tell you how to organize your desktop while working with Rails, but we'll describe what we do.

Most of the time, we're writing code, running tests, and poking at an application in a browser. So, our main development desktop has an editor window and a browser window permanently open. We also want to keep an eye on the logging that's generated by the application, so we keep a terminal window open. In it, we use `tail -f` to scroll the contents of the log file as it's updated. We normally run this window with a small font so it takes up less space. If we see something interesting flash by, we increase the font size to investigate.

Alternately, you can use `less +F` to scroll through messages. This has the advantage of being able to exit the follow mode by pressing `Ctrl-C`, at which point you can do searches by typing `/` followed by the string you want to search for.

Windows developers should take a look at Windows Terminal.[30]

We also need access to the Rails API documentation, which we view in a browser. In the Introduction, we talked about using the `gem server` command to